



Computer Literacy Program 2017 Annual Report

The Computer Literacy Program (CLP) turned **thirteen** in 2017. It is a pleasure to report to you that with your generous help and support, CLP continues to make steady progress in its core mission of *empowering underprivileged rural youths through computer literacy and technology-aided education* through the established Computer Literacy Centers (CLCs) and Smart Class Rooms (SCRs). New initiatives were introduced and some of the older projects were revamped. What follows is a brief overview of the key activities of CLP's thirteenth year.

- ❖ While the current focus is more on sustaining and advancing the established CLCs and SCRs, with some further additions last year, the total number of CLCs stand at 262, associated CLCs at 97 and SCRs at 158.
- ❖ The number of students completing the computer literacy training from the above-mentioned CLCs in 2017 operation year is over 17,000 (more than 117,000 since the inception of the program). Over 170,000 students benefited from SCRs every year. Over 1100 teachers received training, who in turn teach the students. In this year (2016-2017), we have trained 3 new teachers.
- ❖ **Education through Entertainment (EE)**, one of the innovative projects that were initiated in 2016, enjoyed substantial growth during this reporting period. The intent of this initiative is to educate students through entertaining structured activities. The number of entertaining and educational videos that were adapted from open source has increased to 26. The project continues to receive enthusiastic acceptance from students and teachers.
- ❖ The third enlarged and revised edition of **"Esho Computer Shikhi"** (Let us Learn Computers) was published with sponsorship from Green Delta Insurance. This sponsorship enables us to make the manual available to the students at a highly subsidized price.
- ❖ A major accomplishment was introduction of the *Connecting Students Around the World (C-SAW)* Project. The goal is to establish communication (sometimes live through Skype) between students in rural Bangladesh and students in US (and potentially other countries

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through joint projects to foster cultural exchange building communication, self-confidence and global exposure.



- ❖ Another notable effort is developing a digital School Communication Platform (SCP) that provides parents online access to the school through mobile phone. This is a revamping of an earlier initiative known as Connecting Parents' to School.
- ❖ Maintenance and sustenance of the established CLCs and SCRs is a major cost for the program. Even when the sponsor cost shares, the program has to come up with 50% of the funding required to provide full support for a CLC and/or a SCR. During this operation year CLP provided full maintenance to 71 CLCs for which respective sponsors participated in cost sharing arrangement. Remote technical guidance was provided to remaining 191 CLCs and 113 SCRs without cost sharing. Hardware in quite a few of the earlier established centers required replacement. The program delivered 40 desktops (CPU only) and 1 laptop computers this year to the CLCs covered under the maintenance plan. We seek your support for maintenance of these CLCs and SCRs.
- ❖ Celebrated 13 years of achievement (2004-2017) in a lively CLP Annual Event on July 29, 2017 at Rutgers University Center, NJ, USA. A highlight of the event was observing a teacher teach a class at a CLC in Bangladesh live and in real time. One of the guests attending the Annual Event at Rutgers even asked the class a question and received an answer in real time!

Mark your Calendar!

2018 CLP Annual Event is tentatively scheduled for **Saturday, July 28, 2018** at Rutgers Cook College Student Center, New Brunswick. We will contact you with details as we get close to that date. We look forward to your continued active support in the future.

CLP Seeks your continued support

CLP sincerely appreciates your support and donations to maintain its current level of activities. *Your continued support and generous contributions* are crucial to the overall success of the program. Please visit www.clpweb.org for more detailed information on our program.

Please enable Amazon to donate 0.5% of your Amazon online shopping to CLP by using Amazon Smile browser and selecting CLP your favorite charity.

CLP wishes you, your family and friends a happy and successful New Year 2018.

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